THE SI SENTINEL

Weekday briefing on builders shaping super intelligence

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 16, 2026

THE THURSDAY PICTURE

A Roadster that flies, Muse weights that open, and a Star Mind for space

Tesla and SpaceX showed a next-generation Roadster that drove upside down, hopped over a line of Tesla vehicles, and claimed 0–60 mph in 0.81 seconds at a SpaceX test site outside Waco, Texas. Mark Zuckerberg and Meta released Muse Spark Open, an 816-billion-parameter open-weight model meant to run on desk Mac Studios. Elon Musk and Jensen Huang sketched a Star Mind computer for orbital data centers, with Musk saying SpaceX may want more than 10 gigawatts of compute by the end of 2027.

Arthur Mensch told Europe to build frontier AI or surrender it. Sundar Pichai flagged a 40-fold cut in quantum magic-state errors on Willow. Twenty-five of the 45 builders posted. Musk posted 43 times.

I · THE FLYING ROADSTER

Thrusters, suction fans, and a car that sticks to the ceiling

Tesla unveiled a SpaceX-powered Roadster that drove inverted, flipped in the air, and jumped a row of company vehicles. Production is aimed at 2028.

0.81s	3 trims	2028
Claimed 0–60 mph at the McGregor demo, over 3.3 g	Performance, Thrust, and invite-only Rocket with a full flight system	Production start Musk named on stage

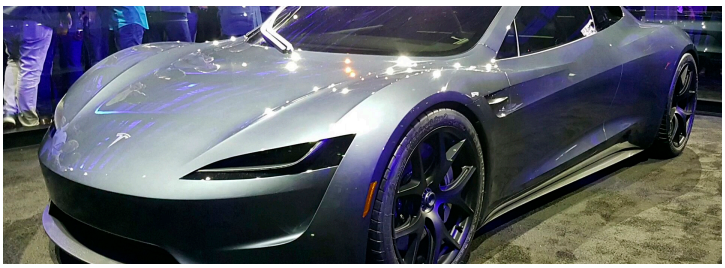
Elon Musk @elonmusk · CEO, Tesla and SpaceX

After the show, Musk posted a clip that passed 27 million views by Friday morning:

> *"Turns out the future does have flying cars"*
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

TechCrunch and The Verge reported the demo from a SpaceX site near Waco: suction fans held the car on an inverted ramp, cold-gas thrusters spun and landed it, and thrusters later lifted it over a Cybercab, Cybertruck, Semi, Model Y and Model 3. Engineering vice president Lars Moravy said 10 thrusters draw on about 600 liters of compressed air in carbon-fiber overwrapped tanks packed into every usable void. Range is about 300 miles; top speed exceeds 230 mph. Tesla is taking a $50,000 deposit for Performance and $250,000 for Thrust; Rocket is invite-only.

Earlier Thursday Musk had teased the stream with "Tesla x SpaceX" and wrote "Success is not certain, but excitement is." After the hop he thanked Sundar Pichai: "It's such an honor working with incredible engineers." Liv Boeree noted the claimed sprint: "0-60mpg in 0.81 seconds is over 3.3 Gs WHAT ON EARTH" — Musk replied, "You're right, we can do better." He also quoted that his original Roadster is "still orbiting Mars and Earth."



The Tesla Roadster prototype at its unveiling in November 2017 — the design Tesla replaced on Thursday with a sharper, thruster-ready body.
PHOTO: SMNT · CC BY-SA 4.0 VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

John Carmack and Ashok Elluswamy @ID_AA_Carmack · @aelluswamy

Carmack, watching the ceiling stick, explained the physics and set his own shopping limit:

> *"That demo involved a non trivial chance of embarrassing failure! I'm only going for the baseline model. At this point in my life, rocket bunny hops are out of my comfort zone."*
> JOHN CARMACK · @ID_AA_CARMACK · POST

On suction without thrusters he added: "Suction fans pulling it down. It doesn't require the thrusters for that... This alone will allow extreme cornering and super hard launches." Musk: "True." Tesla's AI head Ashok Elluswamy quote-posted the company clip with "Sci-Fi company."

Watch-list reactions builders on the hop

Sundar Pichai: "The FSD version of this will be something:) congrats!" Demis Hassabis: "Huge congrats... Blade Runner cars here we come..." David Heinemeier Hansson, who put down $50,000 eighteen months ago, wrote that the first safety question misses the point:

> *"If your first response to the Tesla Roadster is "is that safe??", you've lost all sense of wonder. Safety is not and never was the meaning of life. I'd happily spend a few micromorts on a flying car."*
> DAVID HEINEMEIER HANSSON · @DHH · POST

He later: "And if Tesla offers me the option for Rocket, I will happily add a second Roadster to the fleet!" Aaron Levie tied the night to a longer list: "So in fact we actually can get robots, flying cars, superintelligence, fast internet on planes, space travel, space colonies, orbital data centers, unlimited energy, likely cures for nearly every disease, and more all in our life times. Pretty great." Joe Gebbia, Guillermo Rauch, Tom Brown, Uncle Bob Martin, Palmer Luckey and Tobi Lütke (who resurfaced Musk's 2019 thruster plan) all posted in the same window.

QUICK HIT

Uncle Bob Martin @unclebobmartin on the demo: "Practical? No. Extravagant? Utterly! Beautiful? Absolutely! Will I buy one? No chance. Did I cheer? Enthusiastically!"

II · OPEN WEIGHTS

Meta puts Muse Spark on the desk

Muse Spark Open ships as 816 billion total parameters, 42 billion active, with a one-million-token context — and a pitch that America is back in open weights.

816B / 42B	1M	2 Mac Studios
Total parameters / active per token (mixture of experts)	Token context window	Apple M5 Ultra setup Meta and Apple demoed for local runs

Mark Zuckerberg and Alexandr Wang @finkd · @alexandr_wang

Zuckerberg posted the release at 1:01pm EDT:

> *"Muse Spark Open -- weights releasing today -- runs great on new Mac Studios thanks to work with @johnternus and Apple."*
> MARK ZUCKERBERG · @FINKD · POST

Meta's research blog and Hugging Face describe a natively multimodal mixture-of-experts model built for coding and long agent tasks, with weights on Hugging Face and cloud gardens. Wang called it "the most capable US open-weight model to date" and later posted a 1984-themed clip: "muse spark open. why 2026 won't be like 1984."

Clément Delangue, Guillaume Lample, Aaron Levie builders on the drop

Delangue: "Meta is back!" and showed llama.cpp serving the GGUF on two Mac Studios. Guillaume Lample, who left Meta for Mistral, wrote: "Congrats to Meta on building the best open-weight model in the United States!" Levie said enterprises can mix frontier orchestration with local open weights: "They did it. They made a Muse open weights model, which is a huge step forward for OSS in the US." Yann LeCun congratulated both Wang and Zuckerberg. Michael Dell said Muse Spark Open and Nvidia Nemotron 3.5 Super VL are on the Dell Enterprise Hub with Hugging Face. David Singleton smiled at Apple-era imagery and called the model "legit."

QUICK HIT

Mira Murati @miramurati on Thinking Machines Lab's Tinker fine-tuning service turning customer expertise into owned weights: "One of the best parts of this year... has been watching people follow their own ideas all the way into weights they own."

III · STAR MIND

Nvidia, SpaceX and gigawatts in orbit

Jensen Huang said Nvidia now counts SpaceX with its cloud customers and that the firms are co-designing a server for space. Musk named the machine Star Mind.

>10 GW
Musk's reply when clips said he wants 10 gigawatts of compute by end of 2027

2027
Volume production Musk expects for Star Mind

Elon Musk @elonmusk · on Jensen Huang and Star Mind

Quoting a BG2 Pod clip of Huang, Musk wrote:

> *"Old friends are the best friends. Jensen rocks. The Star Mind computer being co-engineered by SpaceX and Nvidia is far better than almost anyone expects and will reach volume production next year. Working with the incredibly talented Nvidia engineering team is pure joy!"*
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

In the clip Huang says SpaceX has moved into Nvidia's cloud-provider reporting, that Grok Bot demand is "skyrocketing," and that the companies' engineers are designing "a new type of server... that might be super good in space and on Earth." When another post put Musk's ask at 10 gigawatts by the end of 2027, he answered "Maybe more than 10GW."



Frontier at Oak Ridge National Laboratory, June 2022 — a reminder of the terrestrial megawatt scale Musk and Huang are talking about moving, eventually, off-world.
PHOTO: OLCF AT ORNL · CC BY 2.0 VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Musk also amplified Grok Bot usage: "Never seen anything grow as fast as Grok Bot! And there is no free tier, which means people are deriving real value in excess of what they pay." He pointed users at a skill that removes phone numbers from spam lists: "Ask your Grok Bot to remove your phone number from spam call & text lists!"

IV · EUROPE AND THE GRIND

Build, or watch from the stands

Arthur Mensch told Europe not to leave frontier AI to America and China. François Chollet returned to the cost of hard problems. David Heinemeier Hansson called for Sputnik-scale urgency.

Arthur Mensch @arthurmensch · CEO, Mistral AI

Mensch published an essay, "Build or surrender," arguing that Europe must not outsource frontier models:

> *"Should Europe leave frontier AI to the Americans and the Chinese? The idea has gained ground in Europe. It is a fundamental mistake. Build or surrender: for now, the choice is still ours."*
> ARTHUR MENSCH · @ARTHURMENSCH · POST

Paul Graham replied, "It may be too late." Heinemeier Hansson listed Starship, Starlink, Grok and Roadster as moments that "should all have been Sputnik moments for Europe," then wrote that America still compounds while Europe risks worse: "America has plenty of problems too, but they all seem solvable because in the long run compound growth solves everything."

François Chollet @fchollet · creator of Keras

Chollet, whose post Musk marked with a bullseye:

> *"Everyone wants to have solved a hard problem, but almost nobody wants to live inside the grind of actually solving it. The breakthroughs belong to the few who are obsessed with the process, not just the idea of the outcome"*
> FRANÇOIS CHOLLET · @FCHOLLET · POST

Vitalik Buterin @VitalikButerin · co-founder, Ethereum

Buterin shipped a "paranoid mode" agent stack — zkAPI payments, Tor circuits per conversation, cover traffic and local prompt rewriting — and published the code:

> *"Wrapped zkAPI + Tor + extra cover traffic + local LLM prompt rewriting in an open-AI compatible daemon, and made a "paranoid mode" wrapper for my agent harness (pi)... It's getting quite usable! Though you definitely still pay quite a bit in increased latency."*
> VITALIK BUTERIN · @VITALIKBUTERIN · POST

QUICK HIT

Paul Graham @paulg on founders puzzled by investor rejections: "There are two possible explanations: (a) the investors actually are stupid, or (b) they just dislike you, and are making up the reason. And that or is not a xor."

V · QUANTUM AND THE REST

Magic states on Willow, Starlink in the cabin

Google demonstrated magic-state cultivation on its Willow processor. Musk kept pushing Starlink on planes and said SpaceX would likely follow Anthropic on third-party safety evaluators.

Sundar Pichai @sundarpichai · CEO, Google

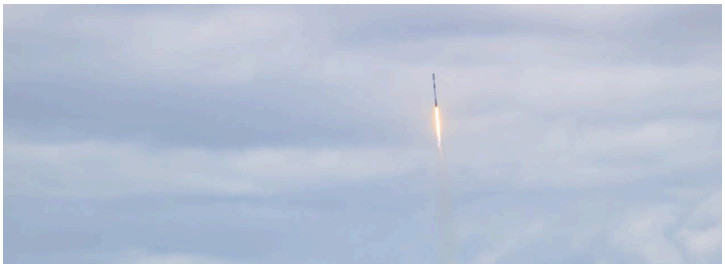
Pichai posted that Google Quantum AI showed magic-state cultivation on Willow, with results in Science:

> *"Some magical progress towards "magic state" in quantum! Our @GoogleQuantumAI team has demonstrated "magic state cultivation" on physical hardware for the first time. The result is a 40x error reduction on our Willow processor vs. previous methods, achieving a state-of-the-art"*
>
> SUNDAR PICHAI · @SUNDARPICHAI · POST

Google's blog says cultivated T-states reached about 99.99 percent logical fidelity, cutting a long-standing resource bottleneck for fault-tolerant machines.

Elon Musk @elonmusk · Starlink and evaluators

Musk quoted a United Airlines Starlink flight checker: "How to find out if your United flight has Starlink super fast WiFi." On Anthropic giving METR employee-like access for safety evaluation, he wrote: "SpaceX will probably do the same." On China's combustion-vehicle share falling to about a third of sales, he posted "China's dependency on oil is dropping fast" and, to a catch-up plea, "We will catch up." Cybercab, he told one reply, "will be a gamechanger."



A Falcon 9 carrying Starlink satellites climbs after liftoff — the same constellation now selling in-flight Wi-Fi that Musk keeps amplifying.
PHOTO: NASA · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Also on the wire

Guillermo Rauch @rauchg kept shipping Vercel announcements from Ship week — backends, Daemons and Drives — then celebrated the Roadster with "TLDR we got Vercel zeppelin and flying cars before GTA6."

Alexandr Wang @alexandr_wang after the demo: "wait who the hell was driving the tesla."

Takeaways

1. Tesla showed a thruster-and-suction Roadster that flies short hops; production named for 2028, with Performance, Thrust and Rocket trims.
2. Meta released Muse Spark Open (816B / 42B active) as open weights tuned for agents and Mac Studio runs.
3. Musk and Jensen Huang are co-engineering Star Mind; Musk floated more than 10 GW of compute and orbital data centers.
4. Arthur Mensch urged Europe to build frontier AI; Paul Graham said it may be too late.
5. Google cut magic-state errors about 40× on Willow; Vitalik shipped a Tor-wrapped private agent stack.
6. Twenty-five of 45 watch-list builders posted; Musk posted 43 times.

On the beat

POSTED · 25

Elon Musk, Mark Zuckerberg, Alexandr Wang, David Heinemeier Hansson, Sundar Pichai, Clément Delangue, Aaron Levie, Guillermo Rauch, Michael Dell, John Carmack, Ashok Elluswamy, Demis Hassabis, Joe Gebbia, Arthur Mensch, Guillaume Lample, François Chollet, Vitalik Buterin, Paul Graham, Tobi Lütke, Mira Murati, Yann LeCun, Uncle Bob Martin, Palmer Luckey, Tom Brown, David Singleton.

SILENT · 20

Marc Andreessen, Jensen Huang, Andrej Karpathy, Sam Altman, Dario Amodei, Patrick Collison, Satya Nadella, Jeff Dean, Fei-Fei Li, Greg Brockman, Mustafa Suleyman, Andrew Ng, Michael Truell, Jim Fan, Noam Brown, Ilya Sutskever, Lisa Su, Nat Friedman, Kanjun Qiu, Mark Chen.

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